Curzon, Churchill's feelings towards Stalin and his regime were also influenced by his previous experiences of Russia.

As for Curzon, his period of supremacy over Britain's foreign relations ended in 1923 when he left the Foreign Office. He had already faced bitter disappointment when, upon Bonar Law's retirement in May 1923, he had been passed over for prime minister in favour of Stanley Baldwin. In 1930, during the unveiling of a statue in London in Curzon's honour, Baldwin would in fact pay homage to the man he believed was indeed more experienced than he when he took the position as prime minister seven years earlier. Despite his bitterness, however, at having been usurped by 'a man of inferior claims', Curzon begrudgingly agreed to continue as foreign secretary under Baldwin until the appointment of the Labour government. However, on the Conservatives' resumption of government, Curzon was yet again disappointed when instead of being allowed to resume his position at the Foreign Office, Baldwin made him Lord President of the Council instead – a role he had occupied eight years previously. Although he acknowledged Curzon's achievements, Baldwin believed that foreign policy needed 'a fresh start'.[18] Despite his incredible talents of administration and his indefatigable work ethic, of which nearly all contemporaries acknowledged, Curzon had not only been denied the highest office of the country, but was effectively demoted. It was a hugely disappointing end to a career which had started with such promise.[19] Less than four months later, on 20 March 1925, Lord George Nathaniel Curzon – probably the greatest of the Great Game players – died of a bladder haemorrhage. As one of his biographers has put it, 'It was the death of a man, but it was also the end of an epoch.'[20]